MED13 Foundation
MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

MEDopathies ALLIANCE
MED12 MED13 MED13L

2026 EVENT SPONSORSHIP PROSPECTUS

An Evening for Answers

The First Annual MED13 Foundation Gala

A cocktail evening in Palo Alto where the families living with MED13 syndrome and the scientists working to treat it stand in the same room. Your sponsorship funds the bridge between them.

WHEN	WHERE	SPONSORSHIP
Saturday, October 10, 2026	Palo Alto, California	$250 – $25,000

A LETTER FROM THE FOUNDERS

Why we are asking you to stand with us

Dear Partner,

Most families hear the words “MED13” for the first time in a genetics appointment, and then go home to a search engine that offers them a list of symptoms and nothing else. No treatment. No trial. No one to call. We know, because that is how our own family started.

In 2025 we founded the MED13 Foundation so that no family would have to begin there. In our first year we built a community of more than 125 families across 17 countries, enrolled families in a patient registry and a natural history study with COMBINEDBrain, and funded the first MED13 stem-cell lines — living models researchers can finally test treatments on.

On October 10, 2026 we are hosting our first gala, An Evening for Answers. It is a cocktail evening built to do one thing: put the people who fund the science, the researchers who do it, and the families who need it in the same room, and turn that evening into the next set of cell lines.

We are a first-year foundation, and we will be candid about that. Sponsorship underwrites the evening in full so that **every gift made in the room goes into research.** We have named exactly what each amount buys, down to a single sample.

We invite you to sponsor this first evening. Your name will sit alongside the scientists and families building the future of MED13 research — at the moment this community is being organized.

With gratitude,



Amy Krystosik, PhD, MPH

Co-founder & President, MED13 Foundation · Arturo’s mom

Sponsors confirmed by **August 30, 2026** appear on every printed piece — the invitation, the program, the signage, and the photobooth backdrop that goes home in every guest’s camera roll.

THE EVENING

Who you'll be in the room with

DATE	FORMAT	LOCATION
Sat, Oct 10, 2026	Cocktail reception	Palo Alto, CA

YOUR AUDIENCE

Families & caregivers
Bay Area MED13 families joining us in person.

Researchers
Scientists working on Mediator-complex biology, stem-cell models, and biomarkers.

Clinicians
Neurologists, geneticists, and developmental specialists who see these children.

Industry partners
Biotech and pharma teams evaluating rare neurodevelopmental programs.

Alliance leadership
Founders of the MEDopathies Alliance, our partners in cross-community research.

Bay Area community
Local business owners, donors, and advocates who show up for rare disease.

THE COMMUNITY YOUR NAME REACHES

125+
families in our community

17
countries they call home

9
advisors on our scientific & clinical boards

3
foundations in the Alliance

WHAT THE EVENING SETS IN MOTION

Gather
Families, researchers, and funders in one room.

→

Fund
Samples, multiomics, and iPSC cell lines.

→

Accelerate
Models researchers test real treatments on.

PARTNER WITH US

Sponsorship levels

Every level includes your name in the printed program and on med13.org. Benefits are cumulative — each tier includes everything below it.

PRESENTING SPONSOR · ONE AVAILABLE

$25,000

An Evening for Answers, presented by you

- → Top billing on every printed and digital piece
- → Remarks from the stage & podium recognition
- → Named in press and pre-event outreach
- → Introduce a speaker or the family film
- → Logo on the photobooth backdrop
- → A promotional table at the reception
- → Year-round logo placement on med13.org

LEAD SPONSOR — $10,000

- → Logo on event signage & the photobooth backdrop
- → Podium recognition from the stage
- → 8 tickets & a promotional table
- → Dedicated social post & website logo

CHAMPION SPONSOR — $5,000

- → Name one moment of the evening with signage
- → Podium mention
- → 6 tickets to the reception
- → Logo in the printed program

CATALYST SPONSOR — $2,500

- → Logo in the program and on event signage
- → 4 tickets to the reception
- → Shared social media recognition

PARTNER SPONSOR — $1,000

- → Name in the printed program
- → Name on the sponsor page at med13.org
- → 2 tickets to the reception

FAMILY CIRCLE · FOR INDIVIDUALS & SMALL BUSINESSES

$500 — name in the program and 2 tickets. **$250** — name in the program, and you underwrite a MED13 family's seat at the table.

$500 / $250

Confirm by August 15, 2026 to appear on all printed materials and signage

READY TO JOIN?

Sponsor a moment, or the whole evening

Prefer to attach your name to something specific? Each of these can be sponsored on its own, at any level, and carries named signage all evening.

Welcome Reception — $5,000

Named signage at the bar all evening, plus your logo on cocktail napkins as guests arrive.

Entertainment — $5,000

Named signage at the DJ booth and a live shout-out during the evening.

Dessert & Coffee — $2,500

Named signage at the dessert table during the closing remarks.

Family Film — $2,500

Underwrite the short film of MED13 families that screens during the program, with a credit on screen and from the podium.

Live Auction & Paddle Raise — $5,000

Put your name on the fundraising centrepiece of the night. Named signage at the auction display, a credit on every bid card, and recognition from the podium as the paddles go up.

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

Sponsorship underwrites the evening in full — venue, production, and the work of organizing and fundraising it — so that **every gift made in the room goes into research.** Our goal for the night is **$100,000** — enough to build complete cell-line models for a cohort of children, with every gift matched dollar-for-dollar by our board up to $10,000.

Three ways to commit

1. Scan the code, or complete the sponsorship form at **med13.org/gala/sponsor**.
2. Email **partnerships@med13.org** and we will send an agreement the same week.
3. Ask us for a 20-minute call — we will walk you through exactly what your level funds.

Replace Edit

Sponsorship form QR code

Scan to reserve your sponsorship level

Sponsorships are also welcome in kind — venue, catering, print, auction items, and photography all reduce the cost of the evening and count at the equivalent level.

Thank you for standing with our families.

MED13 Foundation is a fiscally sponsored project of Rare Village, a 501(c)(3). Sponsorships are tax-deductible less the fair market value of goods received. · partnerships@med13.org

MED13 Foundation
MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

MEDopathies ALLIANCE

COMPANION PACKET · 2026

Scientific Brief

The science your sponsorship funds, and the people doing it

MED13 syndrome is a rare neurodevelopmental disorder with no approved treatment. This brief covers what the MED13 Foundation has built since 2025 — the registry, the natural history study, the biorepository, and the first stem-cell models — and introduces the scientific advisory board guiding the work.

INSIDE
Impact to date

INSIDE
Scientific advisory board

INSIDE
Alliance & partnerships

THE SCIENCE

One molecular machine. Three diagnoses. No approved treatment.

The **Mediator complex** is the switchboard every cell uses to turn genes on and off during brain development. **MED13** encodes a subunit of its **CDK8 kinase module (CKM)**, tethering the kinase to core Mediator. Lose one working copy and the transcriptional programs that build a developing brain misfire.

THE CDK8 KINASE MODULE · THREE GENES, ONE MACHINE

MED13 — 200+ families

ULTRA-RARE · AUTOSOMAL DOMINANT

Tethers the kinase module to core Mediator. MED13-related neurodevelopmental disorder.

MED12 — 200+ families

ULTRA-RARE · X-LINKED

Wraps CDK8–Cyclin C to activate the kinase. Opitz–Kaveggia/FG, Lujan–Fryns, Ohdo.

MED13L — 720+ families

1.5–6 / 100K BIRTHS

Paralog of MED13, in the same structural position in the module.

Losing any one subunit disrupts the same transcriptional programs — the basis for the shared clinical features, and the reason the three can be pursued as one basket-trial cohort.

SHARED CLINICAL FEATURES ACROSS ALL THREE

- Intellectual disability
- Speech & language delay
- Hypotonia
- Seizures / epilepsy
- Cardiac defects
- Behavioral features

WHERE A TREATMENT COULD COME FROM

Gene activation & restoration

All three arise from haploinsufficiency. Strategies validated for one CKM subunit extend to the paralogs, with one readout: neuronal-network rescue in patient-derived neurons.

RNA-based therapies

Antisense oligonucleotides can boost MED13 expression; mRNA-stabilising small molecules are gene-agnostic. One screening infrastructure serves all three.

Drug repurposing

MED13L proteomics revealed an immune-dysregulation signature. If shared across MED13, one repurposed anti-inflammatory could be tested under a single protocol.

Clinical biomarkers

A plasma immune panel found in MED13L is being tested across all three — a pan-CKM panel would enable shared trial endpoints.

WHAT MED13 HAS BUILT

51
families in the Simons Searchlight registry

9
families in our natural history study & biorepository, with COMBINEDBrain

2
iPSC stem-cell lines reprogrammed from MED13 children

EEG
longitudinal recordings banked via COMBINEDBrain

WHY NOW

Structural studies now resolve CKM architecture at near-atomic resolution, confirming MED12, MED13, and MED13L variants disrupt the same interfaces. The FDA's 2026 **Plausible Mechanism** framework opens a pathway for mechanistically related variants to be evaluated together under one master protocol. The infrastructure is in place — what is missing is cell models for enough children to make the cohort real.

Reference: Iyer S et al., *Int. J. Mol. Sci.* 2026;27(5):2221. Counts current as of July 2026 and grow with every newly sequenced child.

Funding the bridge from diagnosis to discovery

For nearly 200 children with MED13 syndrome, diagnosis is where the road currently ends. Every gift tonight funds a real, concrete step in the research pipeline: from a single sample to a living cell model researchers can test treatments on.

TONIGHT'S ASK, BY WHAT IT FUNDS

Collect a Sample
Collection & biobanking for one more child

$1,000

Read the Biology
Multiomic analysis of one child's sample

$2,000

Reprogram a Line
An iPSC stem-cell line, ready to test therapies on

$13,000

FULL JOURNEY

Build a Complete Model
Sample → full multiomic readout → living cell line

$16,000

TONIGHT'S GOAL

Enough to collect the samples, read the biology and build cell-line models for a cohort of children

$100,000

Every gift matched dollar-for-dollar up to $10,000, thanks to a generous matching dono

IMPACT TO DATE

Founded in 2025, and already moving fast

200+
Children diagnosed worldwide

125+
Active families in our community

51
Families enrolled in the Simons Searchlight patient registry

17
Countries our families call home

9
Families enrolled in our natural history study and biorepository, built with COMBINEDBrain

2
iPSC stem-cell lines reprogrammed

35
Families joining our monthly meetups

2
Regional family ambassadors

CROSS-COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

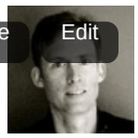
The MED13 Foundation is a member of the **Medopathies Alliance** — standing with the MED13L and MED12 communities to convene a Virtual Scientific Symposium (Oct 9, 2026) and co-host The Meeting of the MEDs 2027.



"Diagnosed at one. Still no treatment. You can help the science catch up to our son."
Amy, Arturo's mom and MED13 Foundation co-founder

Guided by researchers at the front lines of MED13 science

Six scientists advise our research strategy — from the biochemistry and structure of the Mediator complex itself, to the data infrastructure that makes a rare diagnosis findable.



Dylan Taatjes, PhD

UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO BOULDER

Biochemist whose lab helped define how the Mediator complex and its CDK8 kinase module switch genes on and off — the core biology MED13 sits inside.



Kuang-Lei Tsai, PhD

MCGOVERN MEDICAL SCHOOL, UTHEALTH HOUSTON

Structural biologist using cryo-electron microscopy to map the architecture of the Mediator complex, revealing how MED13 fits into the machine and what breaks when it is lost.



Katrina Cooper, PhD

ROWAN UNIVERSITY

Studies the Cyclin C–MED13 relationship at the molecular root of the syndrome, working out how changes in MED13 disrupt the wiring of the developing brain.



Alicia Campbell, PhD

ROWAN UNIVERSITY

Works with Dr. Cooper on Cyclin C–MED13 mechanisms, investigating how the syndrome plays out at the molecular level and what that points to for future therapies.



Melissa Haendel, PhD

TISLAB, UNC · MONARCH INITIATIVE

Director of precision health & translational informatics at UNC and co-founder of the Monarch Initiative. She builds the data and ontology infrastructure that helps rare diagnoses get recognized, studied, and linked to mechanism.



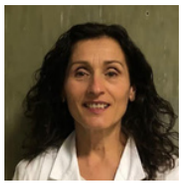
Katja Brose, PhD

LARK SCIENCE ADVISORS · FORMERLY CZI & NEURON

Neuroscientist and scientific strategist with 25+ years launching initiatives that accelerate research. Editor-in-Chief of *Neuron* during 17 years at Cell Press, then Neuroscience Program Lead at the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative, where she built the Neurodegeneration Challenge Network and helped fund the Patient-Partnered Collaborations program. She now advises foundations through Lark Science Advisors.

Clinical advisory board

Pediatric neurologists and clinical geneticists who diagnose MED13 syndrome, collect the samples our research depends on, and author the reference literature other clinicians rely on.



Carla Marini, MD, PhD

OSPEDALI RIUNITI MARCHE, ANCONA (ITALY)

Internationally recognized pediatric neurologist and expert in epilepsy and neurogenetics. She earned her PhD at the University of Melbourne under Prof. Samuel Berkovic, has authored more than 300 publications (H-index 66), and directs the Pediatric Neuropsychiatry Unit at Salesi Children's Hospital. She is collecting MED13 samples and co-authoring the MED13 GeneReview.



Angelica Delgado-Vega, MD, PhD

KAROLINSKA INSTITUTE

Clinical geneticist focused on rare neurodevelopmental syndromes, and co-investigator on our grant-funded research. She co-authors the MED13 GeneReview — the reference clinicians worldwide will turn to at the moment of diagnosis.



Ann Nordgren, MD, PhD

KAROLINSKA INSTITUTE

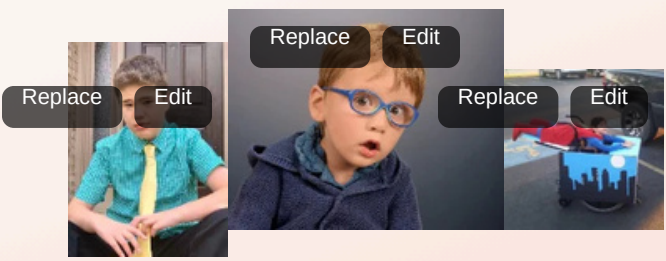
Clinical geneticist whose rare-disease research helps put a name — and a mechanism — to conditions that have long gone undiagnosed. She is a collaborator on our funded research programme.

SAVE THE DATE

Oct 10
2026

An Evening for Answers

MED13 Foundation First Annual Gala



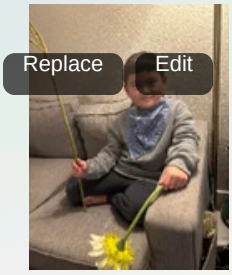
Palo Alto, CA
Invitation with details to follow

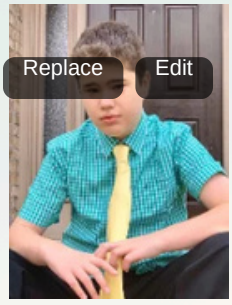
med13.org/gala

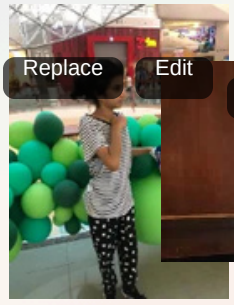
MED13 FOUNDATION · FIRST ANNUAL GALA

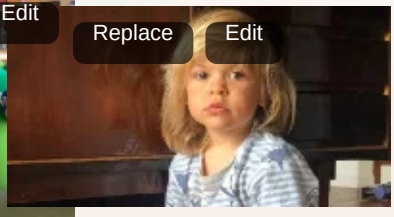
An Evening for Answers

Building the community to journey from diagnosis to discovery together







You are warmly invited to join researchers, families, and friends of the MED13 community for an evening of connection, hope, and impact.

DATE
Sat, Oct 10, 2026

TIME
7:00 PM

LOCATION
UU Church of Palo Alto
505 E Charleston Rd, Palo Alto, CA 94306

RSVP at med13.org/gala

Tickets $100 per person, free for previous donors · Come dressed to dance!
MED13 Foundation is fiscally sponsored by Rare Village, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit. Tax-deductible.

THE EVENING

Diagnosed, but no treatment.
We're changing that.

For nearly 200 children with MED13 syndrome, diagnosis is where the road currently ends. Your evening with us funds the science that builds the bridge from diagnosis to therapy, one sample, one cell model, one discovery at a time.

Cocktail Reception
Signature cocktails, wine & beer bar, and a curated appetizer & dessert menu.

Live Auction & Paddle Raise
Bid on hero experiences and raise your paddle to fund a cohort of cell-line models for children like Arturo.

Music & Photobooth
An evening of dancing, connection, and a digital photobooth to remember it by.

Meet the Researchers
Connect directly with the scientists and families driving MED13 research forward.



"Diagnosed at one. Still no treatment. You can help the science catch up to our son."

Amy, Arturo's mom and MED13 Foundation co-founder

WITH THANKS TO OUR SPONSORS

Sponsor logo | Sponsor logo | Sponsor logo

Attire: Dressy & fun: cocktail attire, bring your party sparkle

Questions: gala@med13.org

MED13 Foundation is a fiscally sponsored project of Rare Village, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit.

MED13 FOUNDATION · FIRST ANNUAL GALA

An Evening for Answers

DATE & TIME

Sat, Oct 10, 2026 · 7:00 PM

LOCATION

UU Church of Palo Alto, 505 E Charleston Rd

Attending as a previous donor? Your ticket is free. Email gala@med13.org to claim it.

Fiscally sponsored by Rare Village, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit. Tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law. Questions: gala@med13.org

ADMIT ONE

General Admission

$100

Free for previous donors

GUEST

CONFIRMATION

GALA-2026-[000###]

THIS EVENING

An Evening for Answers

Saturday, October 10, 2026 · UU Church of Palo Alto

7:00 PM	Doors Open & Cocktail Reception
7:45 PM	Welcome & Our Story
8:00 PM	Live Auction
8:30 PM	Paddle Raise
8:50 PM	Dancing, Music & Photobooth
9:30 PM	Evening Concludes

Draft schedule: confirm final run of show

TONIGHT'S LIVE AUCTION

Wine Tasting for 6
· Parable Wines · retail $1,000
Hidden Villa Exclusive Camping Experience
· Hidden Villa
Colombia Whale-Watching Excursion
· Uramba Bahía Málaga National Natural Park
A Taste of California Avenue
· Destination Palo Alto

Music by DJ Bisi · Hosted by Junior Diala

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STAND WITH

Arturo and children like him



“Diagnosed at one. Still no treatment. You can help the science catch up to our son.”

Amy, Arturo’s mom and MED13 Foundation co-founder

Give in Arturo’s honor tonight

Scan or visit med13.org to fund the answer this family is waiting for

~200 CHILDREN ARE WAITING FOR THEIRS

Fund the science that finds a treatment

Collect a Sample — $1,000

Start the journey. Funds the collection and biobanking that brings one more child's biology into the research pipeline.

Read the Biology — $2,000

Decode what the variant does: multiomic analysis revealing the molecular signature a treatment must correct.

Reprogram a Line — $13,000

Funds the iPSC stem-cell line that becomes the neuronal model researchers use to test therapies.

Build a Model — $16,000

The complete starting point for treatment discovery, from one child's sample to a living, testable model.

TONIGHT'S GOAL

$100,000

enough to build cell-line models for a cohort of children

Every gift matched dollar-for-dollar up to $10,000, thanks to a generous board match.

Give tonight · med13.org · MED13 Foundation, a fiscally sponsored project of Rare Village 501(c)(3). Gifts are tax-deductible.

MADE POSSIBLE BY

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MED13 Foundation

MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

An Evening for Answers

#MED13Gala **med13.org**

MED13 Foundation

MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

YOU ARE NOT ALONE

med13.org